

4th

The 4th Sheet

Your accountant gives you three sheets. I give you the fourth.

SAMPLE DATA · invented figures for demonstration

Sample Community Services Ltd

A Brisbane community services charity funded by six grants, donations, events and program fees. About 18 staff. Registered charity, income-tax exempt.

How final is this data?

September 2026

Locked

September 2026 is locked (closed 2 Oct 2026). These numbers won't change.

August 2026

Locked

August 2026 is locked (closed 2 Sep 2026). These numbers won't change.

October 2026

Incomplete

October 2026 is still in progress: figures to 6 Oct only.

The fourth sheet: September 2026 vs August 2026

Cost to raise a dollar, September

20¢

▲ from 13¢ in Aug

Unrestricted cash runway

2.0 months

▼ from 2.2 months in Aug

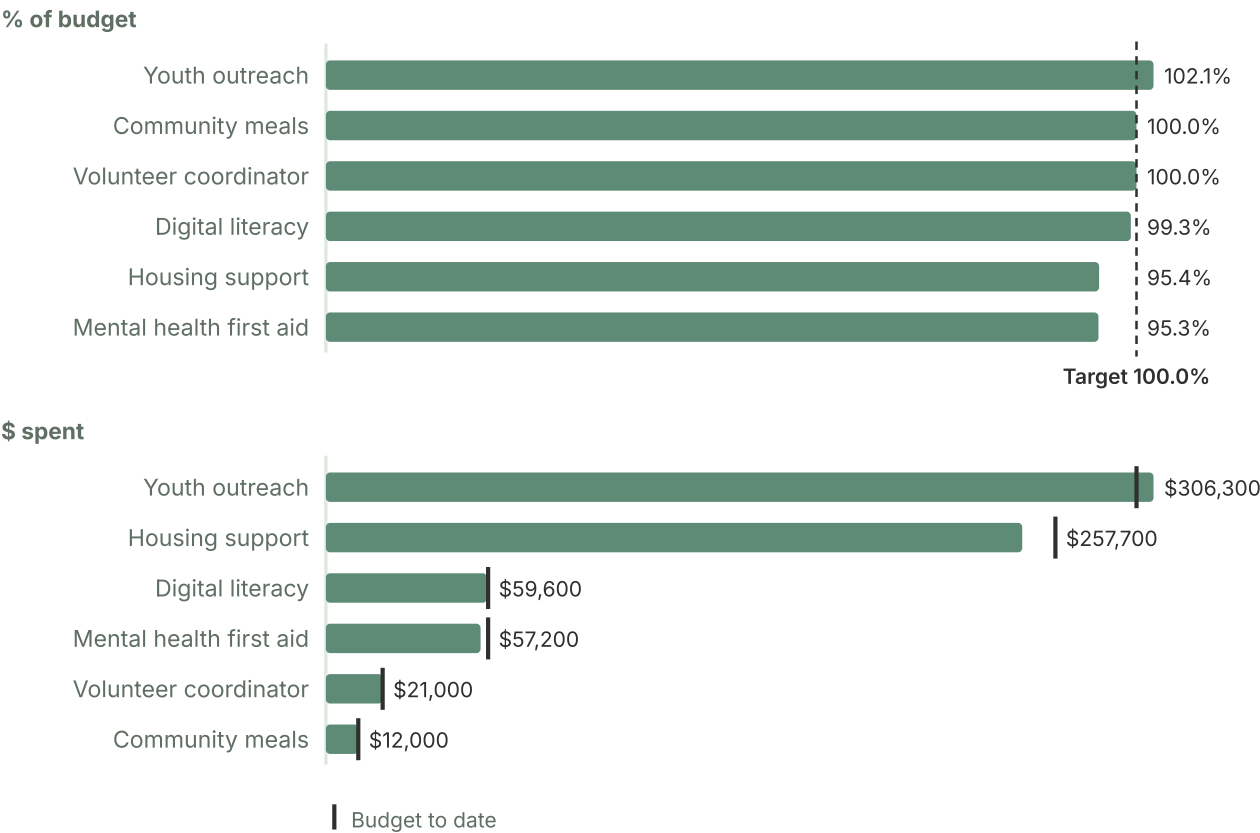
Grants ending in 6 months

2 · \$117,300

still to spend before they end

Each grant: spent to 30 September 2026 against budget to the same date

Whole grant from its start date. Budget to date = the grant spread evenly over its months.



How each number is worked out

Cost to raise a dollar

Fundraising costs ÷ money raised (grants, donations, events), in cents

	Sep 2026	Aug 2026
Grant writing and reporting	\$7,100	\$7,100
Donor campaigns	\$5,400	\$2,200
Event costs	\$16,900	\$2,400
Fundraising costs	\$29,400	\$11,700
Grant income	\$77,000	\$73,700
Donations	\$27,900	\$18,400
Fundraising events	\$41,600	\$0
Money raised	\$146,500	\$92,100
Cost per dollar raised	20¢	13¢

September's gala raised \$41,600 but cost \$16,900 to run, which lifts the month's figure.

Unrestricted cash runway

(Cash at bank – unspent grant money) ÷ this month's cash spending

	Sep 2026	Aug 2026
Cash at bank	\$480,780	\$525,675
Less unspent grant money (belongs to funders' programs)	(\$156,100)	(\$221,900)
Unrestricted cash	\$324,680	\$303,775
Cash spending in the month (expenses less depreciation)	\$162,900	\$141,200
Runway	2.0 months	2.2 months

Reserves target: 3.0 months.

Grants ending in the next 6 months

Grant total – spent to date, for each grant ending soon

Housing support (ends 31 Dec 2026)	\$102,300
Volunteer coordinator (ends 28 Feb 2027)	\$15,000
Total still to spend	\$117,300

Unspent money usually has to be returned, or an extension negotiated, so plan the spending now.

Grants at 30 September 2026

Program	Funder	Total	Start	End	Received to date	Spent to date	Spent Aug	Spent Sep	Budget to date	Spend vs budget %	Still to spend	Months left
Youth outreach	State Department of Families	480,000	2025-07-01	2027-06-30	300,000	306,300	21,500	22,800	300,000	102.1	173,700	9
Housing support	State Housing Program	360,000	2026-01-01	2026-12-31	360,000	257,700	30,500	31,200	270,000	95.4	102,300	3
Community meals	Local council community grant	48,000	2026-07-01	2027-06-30	48,000	12,000	4,100	4,300	12,000	100.0	36,000	9
Digital literacy	Philanthropic foundation	90,000	2025-10-01	2027-03-31	45,000	59,600	5,200	4,900	60,000	99.3	30,400	6
Mental health first aid	Federal health program	120,000	2026-04-01	2027-03-31	60,000	57,200	9,400	10,800	60,000	95.3	62,800	6
Volunteer coordinator	State volunteering grant	36,000	2026-03-01	2027-02-28	36,000	21,000	3,000	3,000	21,000	100.0	15,000	5

Income and expenditure, September 2026

Sep 2026: locked · Aug 2026: locked

\$	Sep 2026	Aug 2026	Change
Income			
Youth outreach grant	22,800	21,500	1,300
Housing support grant	31,200	30,500	700
Community meals grant	4,300	4,100	200
Digital literacy grant	4,900	5,200	(300)
Mental health first aid grant	10,800	9,400	1,400
Volunteer coordinator grant	3,000	3,000	-
Donations	27,900	18,400	9,500
Fundraising events	41,600	-	41,600
Program fees	28,300	26,800	1,500
Interest	1,380	1,450	(70)
Total income	176,180	120,350	55,830
Programs			
Grant-funded program wages	(57,750)	(55,275)	(2,475)
Grant-funded program costs	(19,250)	(18,425)	(825)
Program delivery wages (untied)	(14,500)	(14,000)	(500)
Program costs (untied)	(6,100)	(5,500)	(600)
Total program spend	(97,600)	(93,200)	(4,400)
Fundraising			
Grant writing and reporting	(7,100)	(7,100)	-
Donor campaigns	(5,400)	(2,200)	(3,200)
Event costs	(16,900)	(2,400)	(14,500)
Total fundraising costs	(29,400)	(11,700)	(17,700)
Administration			
Administration wages	(18,300)	(18,300)	-
Occupancy	(10,000)	(10,000)	-
Other administration	(7,600)	(8,000)	400
Total administration	(35,900)	(36,300)	400
Depreciation	(2,900)	(2,900)	-
Total expenses	(165,800)	(144,100)	(21,700)
Surplus for the month	10,380	(23,750)	34,130

Balance sheet at 30 September 2026

Sep 2026: locked · Aug 2026: locked

\$	Sep 2026	Aug 2026	Change
Current assets			
Cash at bank	480,780	525,675	(44,895)
Program fees receivable	10,400	9,800	600
Grants receivable (spent ahead of instalment)	20,900	9,700	11,200
Prepayments	21,000	21,000	-
Total current assets	533,080	566,175	(33,095)
Vehicles and equipment	172,200	175,100	(2,900)
Total assets	705,280	741,275	(35,995)
Current liabilities			
Payables (bills due next month)	65,250	46,525	18,725
Grants received in advance (unspent)	156,100	221,900	(65,800)
Employee leave provisions	166,600	165,900	700
Total liabilities	387,950	434,325	(46,375)
Net assets	317,330	306,950	10,380
Equity			
Accumulated funds	317,330	306,950	10,380

Cash flow, September 2026

Sep 2026: locked · Aug 2026: locked

\$	Sep 2026	Aug 2026	Change
Operating activities			
Grant instalments received	-	-	-
Donations and fundraising received	69,500	18,400	51,100
Program fees received	27,700	26,100	1,600
Interest received	1,380	1,450	(70)
Payments to suppliers	(46,525)	(36,500)	(10,025)
Payments to employees	(96,950)	(93,775)	(3,175)
Net cash from operating activities	(44,895)	(84,325)	39,430
Investing activities			
Purchase of vehicles and equipment	-	-	-
Net cash from investing activities	-	-	-
Net change in cash	(44,895)	(84,325)	39,430
Cash at start of month	525,675	610,000	(84,325)
Cash at end of month	480,780	525,675	(44,895)

Assumptions

The organisation

What it is	A Brisbane community services charity funded by six grants, donations, events and program fees. About 18 staff. Registered charity, income-tax exempt.
Reporting month	September 2026, compared with August 2026
Financial year	FY2027: 1 July 2026 to 30 June 2027

Grants

Youth outreach	State Department of Families: \$480,000, 2025-07 to 2027-06
Housing support	State Housing Program: \$360,000, 2026-01 to 2026-12
Community meals	Local council community grant: \$48,000, 2026-07 to 2027-06
Digital literacy	Philanthropic foundation: \$90,000, 2025-10 to 2027-03
Mental health first aid	Federal health program: \$120,000, 2026-04 to 2027-03
Volunteer coordinator	State volunteering grant: \$36,000, 2026-03 to 2027-02
Grant income	recognised as the money is spent on the program
Unspent grants	instalments received but not yet spent are a liability (grants received in advance)

Other income and costs

Donations	including the spring appeal in September
Fundraising event	September gala: income and costs in the same month
Grant-funded spending	75% wages, the rest program costs
Income tax	none: registered charity, income-tax exempt

Cash and balance sheet

Suppliers	paid the following month
Unrestricted cash	cash at bank less unspent grant money
Cash runway	unrestricted cash ÷ this month's cash spending
Reserves target	3 months of spending
GST	excluded throughout, for simplicity

Checks (all passed)

- ✓ Every subtotal and total adds up
- ✓ Balance sheet balances: assets = liabilities + accumulated funds
- ✓ Cash flow ends at the cash in the bank
- ✓ Surplus ties to the movement in accumulated funds
- ✓ Grant income equals what was spent on each grant
- ✓ Unspent grants equal instalments received less income recognised

Generated 2026-10-06 by a driver-based model: every figure is calculated from the assumptions above. Sample data only, not financial advice.